Everyday AI: Automate the boring bits

12 step-by-step guides for real, everyday tasks

Automate the boring bits

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Before you start — what this is, honestly

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Apps change. Buttons move and menus get renamed. If a step does not match what you see, the guide's online version is the newer one — the link is under every title.

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Automate the boring bits

Create a tiny AI weather-helper widget for your blog with Hugging Face widgets

7 steps · Read online

Ever wanted to add a touch of AI magic to your personal blog or website without needing to write any code? This guide will show you how to find a simple AI weather tool on Hugging Face and embed it as a "widget" – a small, interactive gadget – directly onto your site. By the end, you'll have a custom AI weather helper for your readers.

Before you start

- **A free Hugging Face account:** You'll create this in the first step.
- **A web browser:** Like Chrome, Firefox, Safari, or Edge.
- **A blog or website:** Where you have permission to edit the raw HTML code (for example, a WordPress blog, a personal site built with simple HTML, or a similar platform).
- **Time:** This will take around 15-20 minutes.

Step 1 — Sign up for a free Hugging Face account

First, let's create your free account on Hugging Face. This platform is like a big online library and playground where people share AI models and interactive demonstrations. Open your web browser and go to the Hugging Face website. You'll see a homepage often featuring popular models or news. Look for a "Sign Up" or "Join" button, usually located in the top-right corner of the screen. Click on it to start the registration process. You'll then be prompted to enter your email address and choose a password, or you might have options to sign up using your Google or GitHub account. Follow the on-screen instructions to confirm your email address if required. **If it looks different:** If you don't immediately see a "Sign Up" button, look for a "Log In" button first, as signing up is usually an option from there. You'll know it worked when you are logged into your new Hugging Face account, and you see your chosen username or profile icon in the top-right corner. 💬 Example: `[Enter your Email Address]`, `[Choose a Password]`, `[Click Sign Up]`

Step 2 — Discover a weather model

Now that you have an account, let's find an AI weather model to turn into a widget. Hugging Face is home to "Spaces," which are interactive, web-based demos of AI models. On the Hugging Face website, look for a navigation menu at the top or side of the page, and click on "Spaces." This will take you to a page listing many different AI demos. Once on the Spaces page, find the search bar. This is where you'll tell Hugging Face what kind of AI tool you're looking for. Type "weather" into the search bar and press Enter or click the search icon. This will filter the vast collection of Spaces to show you only the ones related to weather. Browse through the results and choose one that looks simple and functional, usually with a clear input field for a city or location. **If it looks different:** If the "Spaces" link isn't immediately visible, try looking for a "Models" link first, as Spaces are often linked from there, or a general "Explore" section. You'll know it worked when you see a list of AI Spaces related to "weather" appear on your screen. 💬 Example: `weather` (typed into the search bar)

Step 3 — Interact with the model

Before embedding the widget, it's a good idea to test the chosen weather model to make sure it works as expected. This step helps confirm that the AI model (the computer program trained to perform a specific task, like predicting weather) is functional and useful for your blog. Click on one of the weather Spaces you found in the previous step. You'll be taken to its dedicated page, where you'll usually see the "User Interface (UI)" – the visual layout with buttons, text fields, and displays – of the demo. Look for an input box, often labeled "City" or "Location." Type a city name into this box and click the "Submit" or "Generate" button, if there is one. The AI model will then process your request and display the weather information. Make sure the output makes sense, like current temperature or conditions. **If it looks different:** Some Spaces might have slightly different layouts, or they might run slowly on the free tier if they're very popular. Try a different weather Space if your first choice doesn't respond or seems too complex. You'll know it worked when the model successfully processes your input and displays weather information for the city you typed in. 💬 Example: `Chicago` (typed into the city input box)

Step 4 — Generate the embed code

Now that you've found a working weather model, let's get the special piece of computer code (called "HTML") that allows you to put content from one website onto another. This is known as the embed code. On the specific Hugging Face Space page for your chosen weather model, look for a button or icon that suggests embedding or sharing. This is often a `</>` icon, a "Share" button, or sometimes an "Embed" option within a menu — if it's available, it may be located near the top-right of the demo frame or page. Click this option. A small window or panel should appear, providing you with different sharing options, one of which may be "Embed" or "Embed Code." **If it looks different:** If you can't find a `</>` icon, look for a three-dot menu `...` or a "Settings" gear icon, as embed options are sometimes hidden there. Some older Spaces might not offer a direct embed option, in which case you might need to choose another Space. You'll know it worked when a new window or panel pops up, clearly displaying a block of HTML code, often within a text box. 💬 Example: `[Click on the </>]`

Step 5 — Copy the embed code

With the embed code generated, your next step is to copy it so you can paste it onto your blog or website. This code is the key to displaying your interactive weather widget. In the pop-up window or panel that appeared in the previous step, you will see the HTML embed code displayed. There is usually a "Copy" button right next to the code, or sometimes below it. Click this "Copy" button. This action will automatically copy the entire block of code to your device's clipboard, ready for you to paste it elsewhere. You don't need to understand what all the code means; just copy it as it is. **If it looks different:** If there's no dedicated "Copy" button, you can manually highlight all the text in the code box using your mouse (click and drag) and then right-click and choose "Copy" (or use keyboard shortcuts like Ctrl+C on Windows/Linux or Cmd+C on Mac). You'll know it worked when a small confirmation message like "Copied!" appears, or you can paste the code into a simple text editor to see it. Example: `[Click the "Copy" button next to the HTML code]`

Step 6 — Embed the widget on your blog

Now for the exciting part: adding the weather widget to your own blog! You'll need access to your blog's editing interface where you can add or edit content. Log in to your blog's administration area. Navigate to the post or page where you want to add the weather widget. Most blog platforms, like WordPress, offer two views when editing: a "Visual" editor (which shows you what your post will look like) and a "Text" or "Code" editor (which shows the raw HTML). You need to switch to the "Text" or "Code" editor. Find the exact spot in your blog post or page where you want the weather widget to appear, then paste the embed code you copied earlier. **If it looks different:** The name of the code editor might vary. Look for tabs or buttons labeled "HTML," "</>" (angle brackets), or "Source." If you're using a website builder with a drag-and-drop interface, look for an "Embed Code" or "Custom HTML" block you can add to your page. You'll know it worked when the embed code appears in your blog's text editor. Do not switch back to the "Visual" editor yet, as the widget might not display correctly there. Example: `[Switch to "Text" editor, paste HTML code]`

Step 7 — View your new weather widget

The final step is to save your changes and see your new AI weather widget live on your blog or website. Once you've pasted the embed code into your blog's HTML editor, save or publish the changes to your post or page. The exact button will depend on your blog platform, but it's usually "Update," "Publish," or "Save Changes." After saving, visit the live version of your blog post or page in a new browser tab. You should now see the Hugging Face weather widget displayed directly on your site, fully interactive and ready for your readers to use! **If it looks different:** If the widget doesn't appear, or you just see the raw code, double-check that you pasted it into the "Text" or "Code" editor, not the "Visual" one. Sometimes a browser refresh (F5 on Windows, Cmd+R on Mac) can help. You'll know it worked when you see the fully functional weather input box and display on your live blog page, allowing you to type a city and get weather results. Example: `[Click "Update" or "Publish" in your blog editor, then open your live blog page.]`

Common mistakes

- **Pasting into the wrong editor:** Many blog platforms have a 'Visual' editor and a 'Text' or 'HTML' editor. Pasting the embed code into the 'Visual' editor will just display the code as text, not the widget. **The fix:** Always switch to the 'Text' or 'HTML' view before pasting any embed code.
- **Not saving/publishing:** After pasting the code, it's easy to forget to save or publish the page. If you leave the editor without saving, your changes won't appear. **The fix:** Always click the "Update," "Publish," or "Save Changes" button in your blog's interface after adding the code.
- **Widget not loading:** Sometimes, a Space might be temporarily down or very busy, causing your widget to not load. The Hugging Face widget itself can't perform any actions beyond displaying information. **The fix:** Try refreshing the page, or go back to Hugging Face Spaces and try embedding a different, less busy weather model.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You've learned a valuable skill in embedding interactive tools onto a website, which can be applied to many other types of widgets, not just weather. It's a simple way to make your personal site more dynamic and useful.
- **For your business or work:** Understanding how to embed third-party content is crucial for online presence. While this is a simple weather widget, the principle applies to embedding customer support chatbots, interactive data visualisations, or other AI-powered tools on a company website.
- **If you're just getting started:** You've taken your first step into integrating AI tools into your online life without needing to learn complex programming. This process demystifies how many online services share features across different websites.

Try it now

Visit the blog page where you embedded your new weather widget. Try typing in your current city, or a famous landmark city like "London" or "Tokyo," and see what weather information the AI provides!

How to Build a Simple Weekly Schedule in Google Sheets with Gemini

7 steps · Read online

> **In short:** You can ask Gemini, the AI built into Google Sheets, to design a weekly schedule from a plain description of your week — with time blocks, color categories, and a formula that totals hours automatically. You only need a Google account.

Most weeks you can list your time blocks in your head — work, gym, family dinner, the Saturday coffee — yet you never actually write them down. That's the gap this guide fills. In about ten minutes, you'll describe your week in plain English and end up with a color-coded schedule in Google Sheets that adds up your hours for you. The result is something you'll actually open on Sunday evening, not a spreadsheet that dies in your downloads folder.

Before you start

- A Google account (free — the same one you use for Gmail).
- A computer or phone that can open Google Sheets: go to sheets.google.com in any browser, or install the free Google Sheets mobile app.
- Roughly 10 to 15 minutes, and a rough mental picture of what your week actually looks like.
- Some Gemini features inside Sheets are only available on paid Google plans — if you don't see the Gemini option, check Google's official pricing page for the latest plan details. A free workaround: draft the schedule at gemini.google.com first, then paste it into Sheets.

Step 1 — Open Google Sheets and start fresh

Open sheets.google.com in your browser, or launch the Google Sheets app, and sign in with your Google account. Click the "+" button or "Blank spreadsheet" to create a new, empty sheet. Name it by clicking "Untitled spreadsheet" at the top-left and typing something you'll recognize later — "My weekly schedule" works fine.

💬 Example: name it "Spring weekly schedule" or "My week plan".

If it looks different: on a phone, the "+" usually sits in the bottom-right corner; if you only see templates, tap "Blank" inside that section. Menu wording changes often — just look for any option that creates a fresh, empty sheet.

You'll know it worked when you see a grid of empty cells with column letters (A, B, C…) across the top and row numbers (1, 2, 3…) down the side.

Step 2 — Open the Gemini side panel

Look at the top-right corner of the Sheets window for a small sparkle ✨ icon or a button labeled something like "Help me" or "Ask Gemini." Click it. A side panel slides in from the right edge — this is your chat window, and you'll stay inside your spreadsheet the whole time.

💬 Example: type "Hi" as a quick first message to confirm Gemini is responding.

If it looks different: Gemini's exact location in Sheets has moved over the years. If you don't see a sparkle, open the "Tools" menu (sometimes labeled "Extensions" on older versions) and look for anything mentioning Gemini or "Ask." On Workspace accounts, your admin may need to turn Gemini on — if the option is entirely missing, ask your IT admin or check Google's help pages.

You'll know it worked when you can type a question into the side panel and an answer appears in the same panel within a few seconds.

Step 3 — Describe your week and ask for a template

In the Gemini side panel, write a short paragraph describing a typical week. Be specific — even if it feels messy. Then ask for a weekly schedule layout with time blocks, categories you can color-code, and a formula that totals hours per category. Gemini will reply either with a written layout you can copy, or with a button to insert a table directly into your sheet.

💬 Example: "Here's my week. I work Monday to Friday, 9 a.m. to 5 p.m. I teach a yoga class Tuesday and Thursday evenings from 6 to 7:30 p.m. I hit the gym three mornings a week, around 6:30 to 7:30 a.m. on Monday, Wednesday, and Friday. Saturday morning is family breakfast from 9 to 11 a.m. Please build a weekly schedule in this sheet with rows for each day, columns for morning, midday, afternoon, and evening, and a SUM formula that totals the hours automatically."

If it looks different: some versions of Gemini in Sheets can only chat (no insert button). If that happens, copy the layout into the cells yourself — see Step 4.

You'll know it worked when you see either a table inserted into the sheet or a clear text description of where each activity should go.

Step 4 — Build the time-block grid yourself (the easy way)

If Gemini gave you a written description, copy it into your sheet by hand. In row 1, type the days of the week across the columns (Monday in A1, Tuesday in B1, and so on — or use one column per time slot if you prefer). In column A, starting from row 2, type your time blocks: "6:30–7:30

a.m.", "9:00 a.m.–5:00 p.m.", "6:00–7:30 p.m.", and so on. Then drop each activity into the cell where day and time meet.

Example: in cell B2 (Tuesday morning) type "Gym"; in cell C5 (Wednesday afternoon) type "Deep work block"; in cell A8 (Monday evening) type "Family dinner."

If it looks different: some people prefer one row per day and one column per time slot — both are normal layouts. Choose the one that's easier to read on your device.

You'll know it worked when you can read down a column to see one full day's plan, or across a row to see one time slot across the week, without guessing.

Step 5 — Add color categories so your eyes can scan it fast

Highlight the column or row headers by clicking the letter at the top of the column (or the row number on the left), then pick a fill color from the toolbar. Look for a paint-can icon or a "Fill color" button. Then color each activity by type: one color for work, one for fitness, one for family, one for rest. Pick colors that mean something to you.

Example: blue for work, green for fitness, yellow for family time, gray for rest or sleep.

If it looks different: the fill-color icon sometimes looks like a tipped-over paint bucket. On a phone, the same tool lives inside the formatting menu, often marked with an "A" and color bars underneath it.

You'll know it worked when you can glance at the sheet and instantly see which parts of your week are work, which are fitness, and which are family time — without reading a single word.

Step 6 — Add a formula that totals your hours

At the bottom of one day's column, click an empty cell and type a SUM formula. In Sheets, every formula starts with `=`. If you've put the duration of each activity in plain numbers (8 for an 8-hour workday, 1.5 for a 90-minute class), the formula adds them up for you.

Example: type `=SUM(B2:B10)` and press Enter. The cell instantly shows the total. If your durations are in seconds, multiply by 24 first: `=SUM(B2:B10)*24`.

If it looks different: if your time blocks are written as text like "9–5", Sheets can't add them up — they'd need to be plain numbers in a separate "Hours" column. Ask Gemini in the side panel, "How do I add up time blocks written as text in Sheets?" if you get stuck.

You'll know it worked when the total cell shows a number that updates the moment you edit any of the time blocks above it — that's the formula doing its job.

Step 7 — Save once and forget about it

Look at the top-left of the screen for your file name. As long as you're signed in, Google Sheets saves your work automatically every few seconds — there's no "Save" button to click. If you see a small gray "Saving…" message or a checkmark next to the title, you're done.

Example: just close the browser tab when you finish. Next time you open the file, your schedule will be right where you left it.

You'll know it worked when you can refresh the page or close and reopen the file and find your schedule exactly as it was.

Common mistakes

- **Mistake: asking Gemini something too vague.** "Make me a schedule" gives a generic template that won't fit your life. **Always include your real hours, real activities, and how many days — the more specific you are, the better the output.**
- **Mistake: writing time blocks as text like "9–5".** Sheets can't add text up, so your total stays at zero. **Fix: put the duration as a plain number in a separate "Hours" column (8 for an 8-hour workday, 1.5 for a 90-minute class), or ask Gemini how to convert time strings to numbers.**
- **Mistake: assuming Gemini inserted your schedule when it only chatted.** Some versions of Gemini in Sheets can only suggest, not insert. **Fix: read the side panel carefully — if you see an "Insert" button, click it; otherwise copy the suggestions into the cells yourself.**

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** A weekly schedule you actually open turns vague plans into real commitments. The color categories mean you can spot at a glance if "rest" has quietly disappeared from your week — and fix it before burnout shows up.
- **For your business or work:** If you bill by the hour or track project time, the SUM formula and color categories double as a rough time-tracking sheet. Swap the activity names for your projects and you have a one-page weekly dashboard.

- **If you're just getting started:** Don't aim for the perfect schedule in one sitting. Type in the bones of your week today — work, sleep, family — and add the rest over a few days as you notice the gaps.

Try it now

Open a new Google Sheet, open the Gemini side panel, and paste this in: "I teach three morning classes Monday, Wednesday, and Friday from 8 to 11 a.m. I work part-time Tuesday and Thursday from 1 to 6 p.m. I have family dinner every weekday at 7 p.m. Build me a weekly schedule with time blocks, three color categories (teaching, work, family), and a SUM formula that totals hours per category." See what it gives you, change the colors to match your real life, and you've got a planner that took ten minutes to make and will save you hours of "wait, what day is it again?" by next Sunday.

Build a Simple Q&A Chatbot for Your Website with Cohere

6 steps · Read online

By the end of this guide, you'll have a basic chatbot on your website that can answer your most common customer questions. This approach uses Cohere's powerful artificial intelligence (AI) models and requires a simple copy-paste of some code onto your website, making it accessible even if you're new to coding. This chatbot can draft responses, but it won't process payments or manage complex user accounts without further development.

Before you start

- **Cohere Account:** A free or paid Cohere account. The steps in this guide work with a free plan, though paid plans offer higher usage limits.
- **Website Access:** You need administrative access to your website to add custom HTML (HyperText Markup Language) or JavaScript code. This is typically available through platforms like WordPress, Wix, Squarespace, or Shopify.
- **Common Questions:** A short list of the top 3-5 questions your customers frequently ask, along with your desired answers.
- **Time:** Allocate about 30-45 minutes to follow these steps and test your new chatbot.

Step 1 — Create or Log In to your Cohere Account

First, open your web browser and go to the Cohere website at `cohere.com`. Look for a **Sign Up** or **Log In** button, usually in the top-right corner. If you're new, follow the prompts to create your account, which will involve verifying your email address. If you already have an account, simply log in with your credentials. You'll know it worked when you see the Cohere console or dashboard after successfully logging in, which usually displays options like "Playground," "Models," or "API Keys."

Step 2 — Find Your API Keys and Playground

Once logged in, you'll need two main things: an **API key** and access to the **Playground**. An API key is like a secret password that lets your website talk to Cohere's AI services, and the Playground is where you can test how Cohere's AI models respond. Navigate your dashboard to find "API Keys" and "Playground" (or similar names). A new screen will open, showing your existing API keys or an option to create a new one. Click on **Create New Key** if you don't have one, and give it a memorable name like "MyChatbotKey." Then, switch to the "Playground" section. If you can't find these options directly, look for a left-hand navigation menu or a "Developers" section. You'll know it worked when you have a long string of letters and numbers (your API key) copied to your clipboard or saved safely, and you're on a page with a text input box labeled "Prompt" in the Cohere Playground.

Step 3 — Craft Your Chatbot's Responses in the Playground

In the Cohere Playground, you can teach the AI how to respond to specific questions. A **prompt** is the instruction or question you give to the AI, and the **response** is the answer it generates. For a simple Q&A chatbot, you'll provide specific instructions for common questions. Type your first question into the "Prompt" box. After typing your prompt, click the **Run** or **Generate** button, usually found below the prompt box. The AI will then generate a response in the output area. You can adjust your prompt or the AI's settings (like "Temperature" or "Max Tokens" which control creativity and length) until you get the perfect answer for your chatbot. 💬 Example: `As a friendly customer service bot for "My Awesome Shop", what is your return policy?` If the response isn't what you expect, try rephrasing your prompt with more detail. You'll know it worked when the AI generates a clear, helpful response that you'd like your chatbot to give customers for that specific question.

Step 4 — Prepare the Chatbot's Logic with a Simple Code Snippet

Now, you need a small piece of JavaScript code that will connect your website to Cohere's API and display your chatbot. This code will act as a digital messenger, sending customer questions from your site to Cohere and bringing back the AI's answers. You'll need your Cohere API key from Step 2. Open a plain text editor (like Notepad on Windows or TextEdit on Mac, or any code editor) and copy-paste the following basic JavaScript snippet into it. Replace `"YOUR_COHERE_API_KEY"` with the API key you saved earlier, and feel free to adjust the `welcomeMessage` or `botName`. This snippet creates a simple chat interface and makes a request to Cohere's Chat API. 💬 Example:

```
<div id="ai-world-chatbot"></div>
<script>
  const chatbotContainer = document.getElementById('ai-world-chatbot');
  chatbotContainer.innerHTML = `
    <div style="position: fixed; bottom: 20px; right: 20px; width: 300px; height: 400px; border: 1px solid #ccc; border-radius: 8px; box-sha
      <div style="background-color: #007bff; color: white; padding: 10px; border-top-left-radius: 8px; border-top-right-radius: 8px;">
        <h3 style="margin: 0;">My Shop Helper</h3>
      </div>
      <div id="chat-messages" style="flex-grow: 1; padding: 10px; overflow-y: auto; background-color: #f9f9f9;">
        <p><strong>Bot:</strong> Hello! How can I help you today?</p>
      </div>
```

```
      <input type="text" id="chat-input" placeholder="Type your message..." style="padding: 10px; border: none; border-top: 1px solid #eee;
    </div>
  `;

  const chatMessages = document.getElementById('chat-messages');
  const chatInput = document.getElementById('chat-input');
  const COHERE_API_KEY = "YOUR_COHERE_API_KEY"; // Replace with your actual Cohere API Key

  async function sendMessageToCohere(message) {
    const response = await fetch("https://api.cohere.ai/v1/chat", {
      method: "POST",
      headers: {
        "Content-Type": "application/json",
        "Authorization": `Bearer ${COHERE_API_KEY}`
      },
      body: JSON.stringify({
        message: message,
        model: "command-r-plus", // You can choose a different model
        // Add more context or conversation history here for a smarter bot
      })
    });
    const data = await response.json();
    return data.text;
  }

  chatInput.addEventListener('keypress', async function(e) {
    if (e.key === 'Enter' && chatInput.value.trim() !== '') {
      const userMessage = chatInput.value.trim();
      chatMessages.innerHTML += `<p><strong>You:</strong> ${userMessage}</p>`;
      chatInput.value = '';

      const botResponse = await sendMessageToCohere(userMessage);
      chatMessages.innerHTML += `<p><strong>Bot:</strong> ${botResponse}</p>`;
      chatMessages.scrollTop = chatMessages.scrollHeight; // Auto-scroll to latest message
    }
  });
</script>
```

If this snippet looks different from Cohere's official documentation in the future, always use the most up-to-date example from Cohere's developer resources. You'll know it worked when you have your customized code snippet, including your API key, saved in a plain text file.

Step 5 — Add the Code Snippet to Your Website

Now it's time to add your chatbot to your live website. You'll need to paste the code snippet you prepared in Step 4 into the HTML of your website. Most website platforms, or **CMS (Content Management Systems)** like WordPress, Shopify, or Wix, have a way to add custom code. Look for options such as "Custom HTML," "Theme Editor," "Code Injection," or "Embed Code." Paste the entire snippet (starting with `<div id="ai-world-chatbot">` and ending with `</script>`) just before the closing `</body>` tag of your website's HTML. This ensures the chatbot loads correctly after all your site's content. Save your changes and publish your website. If you're using a CMS like WordPress, you might use a plugin for custom code, or navigate to Appearance > Theme File Editor > footer.php. On Shopify, go to Online Store > Themes > Actions > Edit code > theme.liquid. Look for the `</body>` tag and paste your code above it. You'll know it worked when you've saved and published your website changes, and there are no immediate error messages from your CMS.

Step 6 — Test Your Chatbot

With the code now live on your website, it's time to test if your chatbot is working correctly. Open your website in a fresh browser window or tab. You should see a small chat bubble or a simple chat window appear, usually in the bottom-right corner of your screen, based on the basic styling in our snippet. Click on the chat window to open it and type in one of the common questions you prepared in Step 3. Press Enter. The chatbot should send your message to Cohere and display an AI-generated response shortly after. If the chat window doesn't appear, try clearing your browser's cache and reloading the page, or double-check your website's custom code area for any typos. You'll know it worked when you can type a question into the chat window on your website and receive a relevant AI-generated response back.

Common mistakes

- **Incorrect API Key:** Forgetting to replace `"YOUR_COHERE_API_KEY"` with your actual key, or using an expired/incorrect one. Always double-check your API key and ensure it's active in your Cohere dashboard.
- **Wrong Placement of Code:** Placing the JavaScript snippet inside the `<head>` tag or in a part of your website that isn't rendered properly can prevent the chatbot from appearing. Always aim for just before the `</body>` tag for client-side scripts.
- **Not Publishing Changes:** After adding code to your website's editor, you must save and publish the changes for them to go live. Many beginners forget this final step in their CMS.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You've learned how to connect powerful AI models to a real-world application, automating simple tasks and understanding how AI services can be integrated into digital tools.
- **For your business or work:** This basic chatbot can handle routine customer questions 24/7, freeing up your time to focus on more complex tasks and improving customer satisfaction by providing instant answers.
- **If you're just getting started:** You've successfully deployed your first AI-powered tool! This hands-on experience builds a solid foundation for exploring more advanced AI features or customizing your chatbot further.

Try it now

Revisit your Cohere Playground and experiment with refining a prompt to give an even better answer to a common customer query, like "What are your business hours?". Make sure your custom JavaScript snippet on your website is still open in your text editor. Then, on your live website, open the chatbot and ask that question to see your AI in action.

Set up named medication reminders with Alexa+ for yourself or an older relative

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** Alexa+ (Amazon's upgraded voice assistant, on Echo devices and the Alexa app) can speak reminders to a specific person by name, on a daily schedule, at a specific time of day. It's not a medical device, and it won't replace pillboxes or a caregiver — but it's a useful extra nudge, especially for older relatives who live alone.

Alexa+ is the newer version of Amazon's Alexa assistant that runs on Echo speakers and Echo Show screens. The "named reminder" feature is the part you care about here: you can tell it who the reminder is for, and Alexa+ speaks the right words when that person is nearby. This guide walks you through it on both the Alexa app and an Echo device, for yourself or for a parent or grandparent.

Before you start

- An **Amazon account**. Free to create at amazon.com if you don't already have one.
- The **Alexa app** on a phone or tablet (free on the App Store and Google Play), OR an **Echo device** like an Echo Dot, Echo Show, or Echo Spot. At least one of these two — the app, an Echo, or both — is enough.
- The person receiving the reminders needs to be set up in Alexa+ as a **named voice profile** (Alexa+ can learn to recognize a specific voice, then call that person by name). Setup takes about 5 minutes the first time.
- About **10 minutes total** for this guide. After that, reminders run themselves.
- One honest limit up front: Alexa+ speaks reminders when it hears the wake word ("Alexa"), and it works best when the Echo is in the same room as the person who needs to hear it. If your relative is hard of hearing, an **Echo Show with a screen** is the better pick — the reminder also pops up as text.

Step 1 — Open the Alexa app and sign in

Tap the **Alexa app** icon on your phone — it's a blue speech-bubble with a white ring around it. The home screen slides up, showing your devices and recent activity. If you're asked to sign in, type the email and password tied to your Amazon account.

If it looks different: if you don't see the app on your home screen, search "Alexa" in your App Store or Play Store and install it. If the home screen shows a different layout (Amazon updates this often), look for a **person icon or "More" tab** in the bottom-right corner — settings live there.

Example: at the sign-in screen, tap **"Already a customer? Sign in"**, then enter your Amazon email and password.

You'll know it worked when your first name appears in the top-left corner of the home screen, and you can see a list of your Echo devices under a heading like "Devices."

Step 2 — Create a Voice ID for the person who needs reminders

Tap the **More** tab (or three-line **☰ menu**), then choose **Settings → Your Profile → Voice ID**. Tap **"Create voice ID"** and follow the prompts. The app asks the other person to repeat five short phrases out loud, like "Alexa, play music" and "Alexa, what's the weather?" — they don't need to be perfect. When training finishes, Alexa+ knows that voice.

If it looks different: some screens say "Recognize your voice" instead of "Voice ID" — both lead to the same setup. On older Alexa (not Alexa+), the option may be under **Settings → Alexa Account → Recognized Voices**.

Example: the prompts look like this — *"Alexa, who am I?"* and *"Alexa, play my Flash Briefing."* Speak them naturally. If your relative has a soft voice, ask them to sit about a foot from the phone.

You'll know it worked when the app says "Voice ID created for [name]" and you can now set reminders addressed to that person.

Step 3 — Create a named medication reminder in the app

Still in the Alexa app, go to **More → Reminders & Alarms → Add Reminder** (or tap the **+** button on the Reminders screen). Type the reminder, choose the date and time, then look for a field labeled **"To"** or **"Announce to"**. Pick the person you just trained — by name, not "everyone." Save it.

If it looks different: the wording shifts often. On some screens you'll find **Routines** instead — that's fine, a Routine can do the same thing plus more. Also: many Echo Show devices have a touchscreen, and you can create reminders right there: swipe down from the top of the screen, tap **Settings → Reminders → New Reminder**. Same idea, different buttons.

Example: type something plain — *"Remind Mom to take her blood pressure pill"*, set it for **8:00 a.m.**, set it to **repeat every day**, and assign it **To: Mom**. Keep the wording short — Alexa+ reads it back aloud, so it should sound natural when spoken.

You'll know it worked when the reminder appears in your Reminders list with the person's name attached, and the app confirms "Reminder set."

Step 4 — Test it on the Echo, out loud

Walk over to the Echo device in the room where your relative spends the most time — usually the kitchen or living room. Say clearly: **"Alexa, set a reminder for Mom at 8 a.m. every day to take her blood pressure pill."** The light ring on top of the Echo spins blue while Alexa+ thinks, then it speaks back: *"Okay, I'll remind Mom every day at 8 a.m. to take her blood pressure pill."*

If it looks different: on an Echo Show (the one with the screen), the same words work, but you'll also see the reminder pop up as text on the display. If your Echo doesn't seem to hear you, try saying the wake word first ("Alexa...") before your sentence, and speak a little louder than normal — older microphones prefer a clear voice.

Example: *"Alexa, set a reminder for Dad every evening at 7 p.m. to take his evening pill."* Notice you don't need the app at all for this — the Echo itself can create, list, and delete named reminders.

You'll know it worked when Alexa+ repeats your exact request back to you out loud. That verbal confirmation is your success check.

Step 5 — Listen for it the next day, and tweak the time

The next morning at the set time, stand a few feet from the Echo and listen. Alexa+ should say something like: *"Mom, here's your reminder: take your blood pressure pill."* That name in front is the whole point — it's what tells you who's meant to hear it. If 8 a.m. turns out to be the wrong moment (maybe your relative is still asleep), delete the reminder and recreate it: **"Alexa, delete my reminder for Mom."** Then create a new one at a better time.

If it looks different: if you don't hear anything at the scheduled time, check that the Echo is **plugged in, not muted** (a red ring around the top means it's muted — press the mute button on top to unmute). Also, reminders won't fire if the Echo has been unplugged or lost Wi-Fi, so make sure the ring glows blue at the set time.

Example: *"Alexa, list my reminders"* — Alexa+ will read every reminder you have set, including who each one is for. Use this to double-check before the day starts.

You'll know it worked when you hear the person's name spoken out loud at the exact time you set, in the room where the Echo lives.

Step 6 — Add a backup: a repeat chime or visual cue on Echo Show

For an extra layer, especially with someone who doesn't always hear well, pair the reminder with a Routine that also plays a chime or shows a notification. In the app, go to **More → Routines → +** and set it to trigger at the same time as the reminder. Under "Add action," pick **Sounds → Play chime**, or for Echo Show, **Announcements → Display a message**. Save and turn it on.

If it looks different: if the Echo is an older model without a screen, skip this step — the spoken reminder on its own is enough. You can also buy a smart plug and have Alexa+ flash a lamp when the reminder goes off, but that's optional.

Example: under the Routine's "When this happens," pick the reminder you made in Step 3. Under "Add action," pick **Sounds → Bell chime** (or whatever chime the app offers). Save the Routine and you're done.

You'll know it worked when at 8 a.m. you hear both Alexa+'s spoken reminder and the chime — two ways to catch your relative's attention.

Common mistakes

- **Forgetting to assign the reminder to a person.** Without a name, Alexa+ says "you have a reminder" — which is useless if your relative isn't sure the message is for them. Always set the **"To"** field to the specific person.
- **Setting the time too early.** If your relative sleeps until 9 a.m., an 8 a.m. reminder just becomes background noise. Test for a few days and shift the time forward — voice reminders are easy to delete and recreate.
- **Relying on a single Echo device in a quiet corner.** The reminder only works in the room where the Echo sits, and only when it's plugged in and connected to Wi-Fi. For someone who's often in the kitchen or bathroom, place the Echo where the morning routine happens, not in a bedroom down the hall.
- **Treating Alexa+ as a medical device.** It's a friendly nudge, not a guarantee. Always keep using a labeled pillbox, and never skip human check-ins because "the Echo will remind them."

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** if you take a daily vitamin or prescription yourself, you can set a quick reminder from the kitchen counter — "Alexa, remind me to take my vitamin at 7:30 a.m. every day" — without ever opening the app.

- **For your family or caregiving:** named reminders turn one Echo into a gentle, shared checklist for everyone in the household. Mom's pill, Dad's evening walk, your kid's homework time — each person hears only their own name.
- **If you're just getting started:** begin with one reminder, one person, one time of day. Get that working for a week, and only then add more — too many reminders at once is overwhelming, and people start ignoring them all.

Try it now

Set one reminder today. Walk to the nearest Echo and say out loud, plainly: **"Alexa, set a reminder for me every morning at 8 a.m. to take my vitamin."** That's it — one sentence, zero app menus. Tomorrow morning, Alexa+ will speak your name back to you, and you'll know the whole system works. From there, you can add a named reminder for your relative whenever you're ready.

Build a Basic AI Chatbot Brain Using OpenAI's API – Quick Start

6 steps · Read online

Ever wanted to give your website or application a smart assistant? This guide shows you how to set up the core intelligence, or "brain," of a simple AI chatbot using OpenAI's powerful **API (Application Programming Interface)**. By the end, you'll understand how to instruct an AI to answer questions in a specific way, ready for future integration into your projects.

Before you start

- **An active OpenAI account:** You can create one for free on the OpenAI website.
- **Access to the OpenAI API:** This requires adding billing details to your OpenAI account to activate API usage. While free credits may be available, charges apply once these are used.
- **A computer with a web browser:** Chrome, Firefox, Edge, or Safari will work.
- **Rough total time:** Allow about 15-20 minutes to follow all the steps.

Step 1 — Sign In to Your OpenAI Account

Your first step is to log into the OpenAI platform where you'll access the tools. Open your web browser and navigate to the OpenAI website. On the main page, look for a "Log in" or "Sign in" button, typically located in the top-right corner of the screen. Click this button and enter your email address and password.

You'll know it worked when a new screen loads, displaying your OpenAI dashboard or home page, where you might see options for "ChatGPT", "API", or "DALL-E".

Step 2 — Get Your Secret Key (API Key)

To let programs communicate with OpenAI's powerful AI models, you need an **API key**. Think of an API key like a secret password that authorises your requests. It tells OpenAI that it's you making the request and helps manage your account's usage.

Once logged in, look for your profile icon or name, usually in the top-right corner of the screen. Click it, and from the dropdown menu, select "API keys". On the API keys page, you'll see a button like "Create new secret key". Click this, then give your key a memorable name, such as "My Website Chatbot Brain", and click "Create secret key" again. **Important:** Immediately copy the string of characters that appears. You won't see it again after this window closes, so paste it somewhere safe (like a temporary text file) or have it ready for the next step.

You'll know it worked when you've securely copied a long string of letters and numbers (e.g., `sk-xxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxx`).

Step 3 — Open the OpenAI Playground

Now, let's head to the **OpenAI Playground**. This is a user-friendly web interface provided by OpenAI that allows you to experiment with their AI models and API features without writing any code. It's like a sandbox for AI experiments.

From your OpenAI platform page, look for a left-hand navigation menu or a central dashboard button that says "Playground". Click on "Playground" to load the interface. Once loaded, ensure you are in the "Chat" mode, which is usually indicated by a dropdown menu or a tab at the top of the Playground, sometimes labeled "Mode: Chat". If it looks different, you might be in "Completions" mode; simply find the "Chat" option to switch over.

You'll know it worked when you see a panel on the left with a section titled "System" and another below it for "User" messages.

Step 4 — Define Your Chatbot's "Personality" (System Message)

This is where you give your chatbot its core identity! The **system message** is a set of instructions you provide to the AI *before* any conversation begins. It tells the AI its role, desired tone, and what kind of information it should focus on. Imagine it as writing a detailed job description for your AI assistant.

In the OpenAI Playground, locate the large text box labeled "System" on the left side of the screen. Click inside this box and begin typing your instructions. Be clear, specific, and tell the AI exactly what you want it to be.

Example: `You are a friendly and helpful customer service assistant for "AI World HQ" Your main goal is to answer questions about general AI topics and guide users to relevant guides on our website. Be concise, polite, and avoid giving medical, financial, or legal advice. If a question is outside your knowledge or scope, politely state that you cannot assist with that specific query.`

You'll know it worked when your chosen instructions are fully visible within the "System" message box.

Step 5 — Have Your First Conversation

With your chatbot's "personality" defined, it's time to test its brain by simulating a conversation! Below the "System" box in the OpenAI Playground, you'll find a section labeled "User". This is where you'll type a message, just like a website visitor would.

Type a question that fits within the role you defined in your system message. For instance, if you set its role as a customer service assistant, ask a relevant question. Once you've typed your message, look for a "Submit" button, usually green and found at the bottom of the chat interface. Click it to send your message to the AI. If it looks different, check for a "Send" icon or similar.

Example: **User:** `What is AI?` *(Click "Submit")*

You'll know it worked when the AI's response appears directly below your "User" message, often labeled "Assistant" or "AI's Reply".

Step 6 — Refine and Experiment

The power of the system message lies in its flexibility. You can tweak it endlessly to fine-tune your chatbot's behavior. After your first conversation, you might notice areas for improvement or new ideas for its role.

Go back to the "System" box and adjust your instructions. For example, you could tell it to be more empathetic, or to always ask a follow-up question. After making changes, type another question into the "User" box and click "Submit" again. The AI will now process your new message using the *updated* system instructions. Experiment by challenging it with queries outside its defined scope to see how it adheres to your boundaries.

You'll know it worked when the AI's subsequent responses clearly reflect the changes you made to its "personality" in the system message.

Common mistakes

- **Sharing your API key publicly:** Your API key is like a master password to your OpenAI account. Never embed it directly into front-end website code or share it anywhere public, as others could use it to make requests under your account, potentially incurring significant costs. Always keep it secure and private.
- **Unclear or contradictory system messages:** If your chatbot gives unexpected or unhelpful answers, the problem is often in its "job description." Ensure your instructions are specific about its role, desired tone, and what it *shouldn't* do. Ambiguity can lead the AI astray.
- **Expecting the AI to be infallible or magical:** While powerful, AI can **hallucinate** (confidently make up information) or struggle with complex nuances. This process defines its "brain," but the API alone doesn't integrate it into a user interface or guarantee perfect information. Always verify critical details, especially in a business context.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Understanding how to craft a system message helps you get better, more tailored results from personal AI tools like ChatGPT. It teaches you to be a more effective communicator with AI, guiding it to focus on what matters to you.
- **For your business or work:** You've just laid the groundwork for a potential custom AI assistant. This core intelligence can power a customer service bot, a virtual sales assistant, or an internal knowledge base helper on your website or app. It can answer FAQs, provide product information, or assist with troubleshooting, freeing up your team's time.
- **If you're just getting started:** The easiest first move is to spend more time in the OpenAI Playground. Experiment with different system messages and user prompts to see how drastically you can change the AI's behavior and responses.

Try it now

Head back to the OpenAI Playground, update your system message to make your chatbot a "friendly, expert travel agent for the US," and then ask it, "What's the best way to plan a trip to the Grand Canyon?"

Create a personalized workout routine with DeepSeek's multilingual chat

6 steps · Read online

> **In short:** DeepSeek's AI chat can generate a personalized workout plan in many languages — just describe your goals, fitness level, and available equipment, then ask for a weekly routine.

Imagine typing a few sentences about your fitness goals and receiving a ready-to-use, day-by-day workout plan in your language. That's exactly what DeepSeek's multilingual chat can do for you. No gym membership, no personal trainer, just a simple chat and a plan you can start today.

Before you start

- A free DeepSeek account (sign up at deepseek.com).
- A phone, tablet or computer with internet.
- About 10 minutes of your time.

Step 1 — Open DeepSeek Chat

Go to deepseek.com and look for the chat option — it's usually a "Chat" button or "Try DeepSeek" link near the top of the page. If you can't find it, try navigating directly to the chat section of the site. You'll see a clean page with a large text box in the center. A blinking cursor will appear in the box, ready for your first message. You'll know it worked when you see the blinking cursor in a text box labeled "Message DeepSeek..." or similar.

Example: Open your browser and go to deepseek.com, then find the chat interface

Step 2 — Say hello and set the scene

Type a friendly greeting so DeepSeek knows you're ready. This helps the AI understand you're starting a conversation. After you press Enter, the chat will reply with something like "Hello! How can I help you today?" If the reply doesn't appear, check your internet connection or refresh the page. You'll know it worked when you see DeepSeek's welcome message in the chat.

Example: Hi there, I want to build a simple workout plan

Step 3 — Describe your goals and limits

Tell DeepSeek exactly what you want and any limits you have. Be clear about your fitness level, available days, equipment and any injuries. The more details you give, the better the plan will fit you. If you're unsure what to say, just write "I'm a beginner, I have no equipment, I can train 3 days a week, and I want to build strength." You'll know it worked when DeepSeek replies with a summary like "Got it! You want a beginner-friendly, no-equipment, 3-day strength plan."

Example: I'm a complete beginner, I have no weights or gym access, I can train Monday, Wednesday and Friday mornings, and I want to build strength and feel more energetic

Step 4 — Ask for a day-by-day plan

Now ask DeepSeek to create a weekly workout routine based on what you just told it. Use simple words like "create a weekly workout plan" or "give me a 3-day beginner routine." DeepSeek will reply with a clear list of exercises, sets and rest times. If the reply is too long or unclear, type "shorten it to 5 exercises per session" to get a tighter plan. You'll know it worked when you see a numbered list of exercises with instructions like "3 sets of 10 squats, rest 60 seconds."

Example: Create a simple 3-day weekly workout plan for me, no equipment, beginner level

Step 5 — Choose your language

DeepSeek can speak many languages. If you'd like the plan in your language, just ask. Type "please give the plan in [your language]" and DeepSeek will rewrite everything so it feels natural to you. If the language switch doesn't happen, try typing the same request again or refresh the page. You'll know it worked when the exercise names and instructions appear in your preferred language.

Example: Please give the plan in Spanish

Step 6 — Save or print your plan

Once you're happy with the plan, copy it to a notes app, print it, or save it as a PDF. DeepSeek can't save files for you, but it can format the plan nicely if you ask. Type "format this as a printable table" and DeepSeek will return a clean layout you can screenshot or print. If the formatting looks messy, just ask again or copy the text into any document. You'll know it worked when you have a neat table or list you can take to your training space.

Example: Format this as a printable table so I can print it

Common mistakes

- **Too vague**: If you only say "I want a workout," DeepSeek might give a generic plan that doesn't fit you. Fix: Add details like "beginner," "no equipment," "3 days," and "strength."
- **Ignoring rest**: If you skip rest times, your plan may feel impossible. Fix: Ask DeepSeek to include rest periods or look for "rest 60 seconds" in every exercise line.
- **Not checking language**: If the plan is in English and you prefer another language, the exercises might feel unfamiliar. Fix: Ask DeepSeek to rewrite the plan in your language before you start.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life**: You'll have a clear, personalized plan that fits your schedule and language, so you can start today without confusion.
- **For your business or work**: If you manage wellness programs, you can use DeepSeek to quickly draft beginner-friendly routines for colleagues, saving hours of planning.
- **If you're just getting started**: This is the easiest first move—open the chat, tell DeepSeek your goals, and receive a ready-to-use plan in minutes.

Try it now

Open your browser, go to deepseek.com, find the chat, type "Hi, I'm a beginner with no equipment and I want a simple 3-day strength plan," and copy the reply into your notes. You'll have your first workout plan in under two minutes.

Automate Git Commands with GitHub Copilot Suggestions

5 steps · Read online

If you've ever felt overwhelmed by the precise commands needed to save and organize your programming work, or simply track changes to any project, you are not alone. This guide will show you how to let GitHub Copilot do the heavy lifting, turning your natural language requests into ready-to-use Git commands directly inside your code editor. It's like having a helpful assistant for your project's version control.

Before you start

- **Visual Studio Code (VS Code)**: A popular, free code editor. Ensure you have it installed on your computer.
- **GitHub Copilot**: GitHub Copilot has a free tier for individual users. If you need advanced features or are part of an organization, you may need a paid subscription. Check the official pricing page to see what's right for you.
- **VS Code Extensions**: Install the `GitHub Copilot` and `GitHub Copilot Chat` extensions within VS Code. You can find these in the Extensions view (a square icon on the side panel).
- **Time**: This guide will take approximately 10-15 minutes to follow through.

First, let's clarify two essential terms. **Git** is a version control system—think of it as a digital time machine for your project files, keeping track of every change so you can undo mistakes or explore different versions. The **terminal** (or command line) is a text-only window where you type direct instructions to your computer, rather than clicking buttons, like giving specific commands to a digital assistant.

Step 1 — Open your project and the terminal

To begin, we need to open your project folder in your code editor and access the built-in terminal. This lets you ask for help and run commands exactly where you're working.

Open Visual Studio Code and use the "File" menu (top-left) to select "Open Folder...", then navigate to and select your project folder. Once open, you'll see your project files listed on the left. Next, open the integrated terminal: look for the "Terminal" menu at the top of VS Code and select "New Terminal." A new panel will appear at the bottom of your screen, showing a text-based input area. If your screen looks different, you might find a plus (+) icon within the bottom panel that creates a new terminal, or try the keyboard shortcut `Ctrl + \`` (backtick) on Windows or` Cmd + `` on a Mac.

You'll know it worked when: The bottom panel opens and shows a text prompt, usually ending with `$` or `>` and your current folder name.

Step 2 — Ask Copilot for a basic save command

In Git, a **commit** is like saving a checkpoint in a video game, marking a specific set of changes to your project. Before you commit, you usually **stage** your changes, which means preparing them to be included in that checkpoint—think of it like packing items into a box before sealing it. Instead of trying to remember the exact commands to stage and save your files, you can just ask Copilot.

With your terminal open, you'll see a prompt where you can type. Instead of typing a Git command, look for a Copilot icon, or a small text box within or above the terminal panel that says "Ask Copilot." Click on this or use the shortcut `Ctrl + I` (or `Cmd + I` on Mac). A small input field will pop up, ready for your question. What happens next is Copilot listens to your natural language. If it looks different, you might need to make sure the "GitHub Copilot Chat" extension is enabled, or simply start typing in the main terminal prompt, and Copilot might automatically offer suggestions after you type a few words or trigger it with `/git`.

Example: Type: *"How do I stage all changes and commit them with the message 'Added initial project setup'?"*

You'll know it worked when: The Copilot chat box or inline suggestion area shows a generated command, likely starting with `git add . && git commit -m "..."`.

Step 3 — Run Copilot's suggested command

Once Copilot has generated a command for you, the next step is to run it in your terminal. This is where your instructions come to life and Git performs the action.

After Copilot suggests the command, you'll usually see a button or an option to "Insert" or "Run" the command. For example, a small button labeled "Insert into Terminal" or a right-arrow icon might appear next to the suggestion. Click this button to place the command into your terminal's input line. What happens next is the command will appear in your terminal, ready to be executed. Press the `Enter` key on your keyboard. If it looks different, sometimes Copilot might directly offer a "Run Command" button, which will execute it immediately without you pressing Enter. Always review the command before running it.

You'll know it worked when: The terminal shows messages indicating success, such as "[main (root-commit) ...] Added initial project setup" or "2 files changed, 10 insertions(...)", and your files have been saved in Git's history.

Step 4 — Create a new "sandbox" (Git Branch)

A **branch** is like creating a parallel universe or a separate workspace for your project. It lets you safely test new ideas or build new features without messing up the main, working version of your website or application. You can switch between branches easily, keeping your experiments separate until they're ready.

Open the Copilot chat box in your terminal again (either by clicking its icon or using `Ctrl/Cmd + I`). Now, ask Copilot to help you set up a new isolated space for your work. What happens next is Copilot will suggest the Git command to create and switch to this new branch in one go. If it looks different, ensure your Copilot Chat panel is visible; you might need to expand the bottom panel further to see it clearly, or just type your request directly into the main terminal prompt and wait for the inline suggestion.

Example: Type: *"Create a new branch and switch to it, name it 'feature/contact-page-update'."*

You'll know it worked when: Copilot suggests a command similar to `git checkout -b feature/contact-page-update`, ready for you to insert and run.

Step 5 — Safely combine your work (Git Merge)

Once you're happy with your changes in your sandbox branch (e.g., `feature/contact-page-update`), you'll want to bring them back into your main project. This process is called **merging**. Copilot makes this safe by reminding you of the correct order of steps, ensuring you don't accidentally overwrite your hard work.

Trigger the Copilot chat in your terminal once more. In the prompt, explain what you want to achieve. What happens next is Copilot understands that merging often involves a sequence of commands (first switching back to your main branch, then performing the merge). It will provide you with clear, distinct commands to follow. If it looks different, or Copilot only gives you one command, you can refine your prompt by asking: "Can you give me the *full sequence* of commands to merge...?"

Example: Type: *"How do I merge my current branch (feature/contact-page-update) back into the main branch?"*

You'll know it worked when: Copilot suggests a sequence, typically starting with `git checkout main` followed by `git merge feature/contact-page-update`, ensuring a smooth process.

Common mistakes

- **Blindly running commands:** Always read the command Copilot suggests before pressing Enter or the "Run" button. While AI is incredibly helpful, it doesn't know your project's specific history or nuances as well as you do. **Fix:** Take a moment to read the command and understand what `git add`, `git commit`, `git checkout`, or `git merge` actually do. If unsure, ask Copilot: *"Can you explain what this command means?"*
- **Forgetting your location:** Before running a command to save or merge, make sure you are in the correct project folder in your terminal. Running Git commands in the wrong folder can lead to errors or applying changes to the wrong project. **Fix:** If you're unsure, ask Copilot: *"How do I check which folder I am currently in?"* or simply type `pwd` (print working directory) and press Enter to see your current path.
- **Not providing enough context:** If Copilot gives a generic or unhelpful suggestion, it might not have enough information about your goal. For instance, just saying "merge" isn't as helpful as "merge my 'feature/design' branch into the 'main' branch." **Fix:** Be specific with your requests, mentioning branch names, commit messages, or what files you've changed.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You no longer need to keep a notebook of confusing technical commands next to your keyboard. You can focus on creating and building your project rather than memorising complex syntax or looking up commands online. Copilot acts as your memory aid and guide.
- **For your business or work:** New team members can get up to speed with your team's project workflow much faster, reducing the time spent troubleshooting simple file-saving mistakes. It lowers the barrier to entry for contributing to technical projects.
- **If you're just getting started:** Use Copilot as an interactive tutor. Instead of just running the commands, ask it: *"Can you explain what each part of this command does?"* or *"Why do I need to stage files before committing?"* to learn the underlying concepts as you go.

Try it now

Let's do a quick test. Open Visual Studio Code and your project's integrated terminal. Trigger the Copilot chat (click its icon or `Ctrl/Cmd + I`), and then type: **"How do I check the status of my current files?"**

Watch how quickly it suggests `git status`—the foundational command to see what changes are pending or have been made in your project. This simple command is your first step to understanding your project's current state with Git, and Copilot helps you find it instantly.

How to Add an AI Step to Your Zapier Workflow

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** In the regular Zap editor, look for the **AI by Zapier** action, type the instructions you want it to follow, and optionally hand it a small list of tools (like "send a Slack message" or "create a Google Sheet row"). No separate "agent" product to learn — it's just one step in the workflow you're already editing.

If you already use **Zapier** — the service that connects your apps so something happening in one automatically triggers something in another — there's a new way to make a Zap smarter. According to Zapier, the AI capabilities that used to live in a separate product called Zapier Agents have been folded directly into the regular Zap editor as a single **AI by Zapier** action. You drop it in like any other step, write a plain-language instruction, and pick which tools (small actions like "send an email" or "add a row to a spreadsheet") the AI is allowed to call on while doing its job.

This guide walks through that exact process, from opening an existing Zap to testing the AI step end-to-end. It's written for someone who has built a basic Zap before but has never added an AI step.

Before you start

- A **Zapier account** — a free plan works for basic Zaps, but the AI step's usage may count toward an AI actions limit depending on your plan, so check Zapier's current pricing page if you plan to run it heavily.
- An existing **Zap** (or the willingness to build a short two-step one to practice on). The AI step is just a third piece in that chain.
- Roughly **10–15 minutes** for the first run-through, including testing.
- The apps you want the AI to reach — for example Gmail, Slack, Google Sheets, or a calendar — already connected to your Zapier account.

Step 1 — Open the Zap you want to enhance

In your Zapier dashboard, find the Zap you want to add AI to and click to open it in the editor. You'll land on the visual workflow view, where each step is a card stacked vertically with arrows between them. If you've never built a Zap before, create a simple one first (a trigger plus one action) so you have something to work with. The trigger is the event that starts the Zap ("a new row in Google Sheets"), and each action is something the Zap does in another app. If your screen shows a list of Zaps instead of a workflow, click the name of the Zap you want to edit. **You'll know it worked when you see the numbered step cards and the path between them.**

Step 2 — Add the AI by Zapier action between your trigger and your final step

Click the **"+" between two existing steps** (or after your trigger if your Zap has no actions yet). A small panel opens with a list of apps. Type **"AI by Zapier"** into the search bar. When the result appears, click it. Zapier then asks which AI action you want to use — for a general-purpose step that can also call other apps, choose **"Use AI"** (the option that lets you write a custom prompt). The action is added as a new card in your workflow. If you don't find a "+" between steps, look for an **"Add step"** button below the trigger instead — Zapier's editor layout shifts occasionally. **You'll know it worked when a new card labeled "AI by Zapier" appears in your workflow, right between the cards that come before and after it.**

Step 3 — Write the prompt the AI will read each time it runs

Click the new **AI by Zapier** card to open its settings. You'll see a field labeled something like **"What should this AI do?"** or **"Prompt"** — the exact label can shift as the product changes, but it's the one big text area at the top of the card. Type the instruction in plain English, exactly as you'd explain the task to a person. Be specific about the input the AI will receive (usually data from your trigger step) and the output you want back. You can reference data from earlier steps by clicking a **field reference** button or similar icon next to the prompt box — it lets you insert variables from the trigger (like the email subject or the spreadsheet row) so the AI sees real data, not placeholders. **You'll know it worked when you can see at least one piece of data from a previous step referenced inside the text — usually shown as a small colored chip or a label like `1. Subject`. Example:** `Read the email below and tell me in one sentence whether the customer is happy, neutral, or upset. Email subject: {{1. Subject}} Email body: {{1. Body}}`

Step 4 — Tell the AI which tools it's allowed to use

Still inside the AI step, scroll to a section labeled something like **"Tools"** or **"Available actions"**. This is where you decide what the AI is allowed to do besides read the prompt. Click **"Add a tool"** (or a similarly worded button) and choose from the apps already connected to your account — for example "Gmail: Send Email", "Slack: Send Channel Message," "Google Sheets: Create Row," or "Calendar: Create Event." Add only the tools the AI actually needs for this task; more tools means more chances for the AI to choose the wrong one. Each tool you add opens a small configuration panel where you fill in the recipient, the channel, the spreadsheet, and so on — you can either set those values yourself in advance (a static "send to this address") or leave them for the AI to fill in from the prompt. If you don't see a Tools area, you may be on a simpler version of the step that only returns a text answer — in that case, skip to Step 5 and come back to tools later. **You'll know it worked when each tool you added appears as a sub-card inside the AI step, with its fields either pre-filled or marked for the AI to fill in.**

Step 5 — Test the AI step before turning the Zap on

Click the **"Test"** or **"Test action"** button on the AI card. It runs your prompt once with a real (or sample) piece of data from your trigger and shows you exactly what the AI wrote back, plus which tools it chose to call and what it sent to them. Read the output carefully — this is your chance to catch a prompt that's too loose or a tool the AI is misusing. If the answer is off, click back into the prompt, tighten the wording (for example, add "Reply in exactly one sentence" or "Only use the Slack tool when the customer is upset"), and test again. When the output looks right, click **"Continue"** or **"Done editing"** to save, then turn the Zap on with the toggle at the top of the editor. **You'll know it worked when the test panel shows a non-empty AI response and, if you added tools, a short log of which tool ran and what it did — and your Zap's status switch shows "On."**

Common mistakes

- **Writing a vague prompt.** "Summarize this email" gives you uneven results; "Reply in one sentence saying whether the customer is happy, neutral, or upset, and explain your answer in plain English" gives you something you can rely on.
- **Giving the AI too many tools.** If you add Gmail, Slack, Sheets, and Calendar all at once, the AI has to guess which one fits. Stick to the one or two tools this step actually needs.
- **Skipping the test step.** The test is the only place you'll see what the AI actually does before it runs on real data for real people. If you don't test, you're publishing blind — and AI mistakes (wrong recipients, wrong tone) are easy to miss without that preview.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** A Zap with an AI step can quietly sort your incoming email — flagging the urgent ones, drafting short replies, or pushing the important ones into a priority folder — so your inbox doesn't eat your morning.
- **For your business or work:** You can build Zaps that read new support tickets, summarize each one, and post a short digest into a team Slack channel, without anyone manually copying text from one app to another.
- **If you're just getting started:** The easiest first Zap with AI is one trigger you trust (like "new email in Gmail") plus the AI step with just a prompt and no extra tools — that lets you see the AI's plain-text answer in the Zap history and decide from there whether to give it tools.

Try it now

Open any Zap you already have, add an **AI by Zapier** action right after it, and write this prompt in the prompt box: `Read the file under the file upload here and let me know what it's about in 2 sentences.` Then run the test. You'll see exactly how the AI step talks, what its output looks like, and whether you want to give it tools — all in under two minutes.

How to Plan a Simple Weekly Workout Routine That Fits Your Real Life

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** A working weekly plan is built around your real week, not an ideal one — pick 3-4 sessions, match them to the time and gear you actually have, and keep one rule: when life gets busy, shorten the session, never skip it. This guide walks you through that in five concrete steps.

A workout routine only works if you can actually do it on a normal week — the one with the late meeting, the kid who woke up sick, the grocery run that ran long. The plan below takes about 20 minutes to set up once, then lives in your notes app. It's intentionally boring, because boring plans get repeated.

Before you start

- A notebook, a notes app, or a piece of paper — anything you can carry or pin to a fridge
- A rough idea of which days of your week are usually free (most people pick 3-4)
- A list of what you have access to: bodyweight only, dumbbells, a gym, a park bench, a yoga mat
- About 20 minutes for the first setup, then 2 minutes a week to check in on Sunday
- No apps, no accounts, no paid plans — this is a thinking exercise, not a subscription
- This guide does not replace a doctor, physiotherapist, or certified trainer. If you have a health condition, an old injury, or you're returning after a long break, get a quick medical check first.

Step 1 — Pick your weekly "training windows"

Sit down and look at the next seven days as they actually are — not as you wish they were. Mark every half-hour block that is already spoken for: work, commute, school run, dinner, sleep. What's left is your real availability. Now pick 3 or 4 blocks of 30 to 45 minutes and write them down by day and time. Be honest: if Saturday morning is your only quiet window, that's your anchor session — work the rest around it.

Example: "Tuesday 7:00am, Thursday 7:00am, Saturday 8:30am, Sunday 5:00pm (backup)."

If it looks different: if your week is unpredictable (shift work, freelancing), pick a weekly *quota* instead — "4 sessions this week, in any order" — and place them on the day they become possible. You'll know it worked when you can point at the calendar and say "this is when I train" without re-thinking it.

Step 2 — Match each window to a session type

A balanced week usually mixes three things: something that makes your heart work (cardio, like brisk walking, cycling, or jumping rope), something that challenges your muscles (strength — push-ups, squats, dumbbells, resistance bands), and something gentle that keeps you moving without strain (mobility — stretching, yoga, a slow walk). Slot them so the harder days are spaced out. A common beginner rhythm is strength on day 1, cardio on day 2, mobility on day 3, strength again on day 4. Write the session type next to each window from Step 1.

Example: "Tuesday — strength 25 min • Thursday — cardio 30 min • Saturday — strength 30 min • Sunday — mobility 20 min."

If it looks different: if you only have three windows, drop one strength session and keep one cardio, one strength, one mobility. If you only have two, alternate weeks between cardio-focus and strength-focus. You'll know it worked when each window has a clear label and you're not staring at the calendar on Tuesday wondering "what was I supposed to do?"

Step 3 — Build a starter set of exercises (5 to 7 moves per session)

Pick exercises you can do with the gear you marked down in *Before you start*. For most beginners, a full-body strength session needs only a squat (or sit-to-stand from a chair), a push-up (against a wall, a table, or the floor — any version counts), a plank, a glute bridge, and a row (with a bag of books if you have no weights). For cardio, the move that works best is the one you'll actually repeat — walking, cycling, dancing in your kitchen, all count. For mobility, pick five stretches for the areas that feel tight after your day. Write the moves in a simple list, in the order you'll do them.

Example: "Strength — 1) squats 10×3, 2) push-ups 8×3, 3) plank 20 sec ×3, 4) glute bridge 12×3, 5) backpack row 10 each arm ×3."

If it looks different: if a move hurts or feels wrong in your body, swap it — there is almost always a gentler version. You'll know it worked when you can read your own list and picture yourself doing each move without needing a video.

Step 4 — Set a "minimum useful session" (the busy-week rule)

This is the most important step, because it decides whether your routine survives a hard week. For each session type, write down the smallest version that still counts as a workout: 10 minutes of brisk walking is a cardio session. 3 sets of 5 squats and 3 sets of 5 push-ups is a strength

session. 5 minutes of stretching is a mobility session. Write these minimums next to your main plan. The rule is simple: when life gets busy, you do the minimum, never skip the session entirely. A 10-minute walk is infinitely better than a 0-minute plan you feel guilty about.

Example: "Minimum strength = 3×5 squats + 3×5 push-ups. Minimum cardio = 10 min walk around the block. Minimum mobility = 5 min stretch before bed."

If it looks different: if even the minimum feels impossible that day, drop to 2 minutes of any movement and count it. You'll know it worked when you have, on paper, a "bad day" version of every session that takes less than 15 minutes total.

Step 5 — Do a 2-minute Sunday check-in

Every Sunday, look at the coming week. Move sessions if a meeting shifted, swap days if your kid has a recital, decide now which days are realistic. Write the new version in your notes. This is the difference between people who train for years and people who stop after three weeks — they plan the week before the week, not the morning of. The check-in also lets you notice patterns: if you keep missing Thursday mornings, Thursday morning is not your training window. Change the day, don't fight the day.

Example: "Sun check — moving Thursday to Friday because of the team offsite. Sat 8:30am still good."

If it looks different: if you forget the Sunday check-in, do it whenever you remember — Monday morning, Tuesday night. A check-in that happens late beats a perfect one that doesn't happen. You'll know it worked when you can say "here's my week" in one sentence, without scrolling through your phone.

Common mistakes

- **Mistake: copying a "perfect" 6-day plan from a fitness influencer.** Fix: cut it in half. Three sessions you actually do will beat six sessions you quit in three weeks. Add a day only after four consistent weeks.
- **Mistake: making every session long and intense.** Fix: shorter, easier sessions done often beat occasional heroic ones. If you finish a session thinking "I could have done more," the dose is right for building the habit.
- **Mistake: skipping a session because you missed the "scheduled" day.** Fix: do the minimum version that day, or shift the day by 24 hours. A routine that bends survives; a routine that breaks from one missed Tuesday is too brittle.
- **Mistake: changing exercises every week because something new looked fun.** Fix: keep the same 5-7 moves for at least 4 weeks so you can actually measure progress. Boredom, here, is a feature.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** you'll spend about 90-150 minutes a week training — less than two episodes of a TV show — and most of the rest of the week you'll feel slightly more capable walking up stairs, carrying groceries, and sleeping well.
- **For your business or work:** regular movement is one of the cheapest ways to protect focus and energy during a heavy week. A 20-minute walk between meetings is a known reset for the brain, not a luxury.
- **If you're just getting started:** ignore everything else in this guide except Steps 1 and 4. Pick three days. Write down a minimum version of each session. Start next week. Everything else is fine-tuning.

Try it now

Open your notes app right now, write the days and times of your next three training windows, and put the smallest possible session next to each one — even if it's just "10-minute walk." That's your week 1. Everything else can wait.

Organize Your Daily Schedule by Voice with Alexa+

6 steps · Read online

Ever wished you had a personal assistant to keep track of your daily tasks and appointments? This guide will show you how to use your Alexa+ enabled device to set reminders and manage your calendar, all with the power of your voice. By the end, you'll be able to add and adjust your schedule effortlessly, making sure you never miss a beat.

Before you start

- An **Alexa-enabled device** (like an Echo speaker or a smart display) that's already set up and connected to Wi-Fi.
- The **Alexa app** installed on your smartphone or tablet, logged in with your Amazon account.
- A **free Amazon account**.
- A **digital calendar service** (like Google Calendar, Apple Calendar, or Outlook Calendar) if you plan to manage calendar events.
- Rough total time: 10-15 minutes.

Step 1 — Check Your Alexa+ Device is Ready

To begin, make sure your Alexa+ device is connected and ready to respond. This foundational step ensures Alexa+ can hear you and interact with your personal schedule. Your Alexa+ device, whether it's a speaker or a smart display, acts as your voice-controlled assistant, and it needs to be online and linked to your Amazon account to work.

You'll usually see your Alexa+ device with a blue light or a display screen showing a clock, indicating it's powered on and connected. Once you speak the "wake word" (the phrase that gets Alexa+'s attention, like saying "Alexa"), the light will illuminate or the screen will animate, showing it's listening. If you don't see any lights or the device doesn't respond, try unplugging it for 30 seconds and plugging it back in, or check its Wi-Fi connection in the Alexa app under "Devices."

You'll know it worked when **you can say "Alexa, what time is it?" and your device responds with the current time.**

Step 2 — Link Your Digital Calendar

To manage calendar events using your voice, Alexa+ needs permission to connect to your existing digital calendar. This is like giving your personal assistant access to your diary so they can add or check appointments for you. By linking your calendar, any events you create or modify through Alexa+ will sync automatically with your chosen calendar service.

Open the **Alexa app** on your smartphone or tablet. Look for the "More" button, often represented by three horizontal lines or dots, usually located in the bottom right corner of the screen. Tap it to open a menu. From the menu, find and tap "Settings," then scroll down and select "Calendar." You'll see options to link various popular calendar services. Tap "Add Account," choose your preferred calendar (e.g., Google, Apple, Outlook), and follow the on-screen prompts to sign in and grant permission.

You'll know it worked when **your chosen calendar service is listed under "Linked Calendars" in the Alexa app, and you see a confirmation message in the app that your account is connected.**

Step 3 — Create a Voice Reminder

Now that Alexa+ is ready, let's set your first voice reminder. A reminder is a simple alert that Alexa+ will speak at a specific time, perfect for remembering everyday tasks like taking out the rubbish or calling a friend. It's like having a sticky note that talks to you when it's time to act.

Approach your Alexa+ device and clearly say your "wake word" followed by your instruction. Keep your voice natural and clear. Alexa+ will process your request, using its artificial intelligence to understand what you're asking. Once it understands, it will confirm the reminder details with you. If it sounds different, try rephrasing your request.

Example: "Alexa, remind me to water the plants at 3 PM today."

You'll know it worked when **Alexa+ says, "Okay, I'll remind you to water the plants at 3 PM today," or a similar confirmation.**

Step 4 — Add a Calendar Event by Voice

Moving beyond simple reminders, you can also add more detailed events directly to your digital calendar using just your voice. This is great for scheduling appointments, meetings, or social gatherings. Since you've already linked your calendar, Alexa+ can place these events precisely where they belong in your schedule.

Start by saying your "wake word," then clearly state the event you want to add, including the name, date, and time. Alexa+ will listen and interpret your request, then use the linked calendar from Step 2 to add the event. Sometimes it might ask for more details, like which calendar to use if you have multiple linked, or to confirm the event name. If it seems confused, try giving more specific details in your instruction.

Example: "Alexa, add 'dentist appointment' to my calendar for next Tuesday at 10:30 AM."

You'll know it worked when **Alexa+ says, "Okay, I've added 'dentist appointment' to your calendar for next Tuesday at 10:30 AM," and the event appears in your digital calendar app on your phone.**

Step 5 — Check Your Upcoming Schedule

With reminders and events set, it's helpful to quickly review what's coming up. Alexa+ can easily read out your schedule, acting like your helpful secretary giving you a quick overview of your day or week. This saves you from having to look at your phone or computer every time you want to know what's next.

To check your schedule, simply use your "wake word" followed by a question about your reminders or calendar. Alexa+ will access the information it has stored (for reminders) and your linked calendar (for events) and read the details aloud. If it lists things you weren't expecting, it might be accessing a different linked calendar than you intended, or picking up old reminders.

Example: "Alexa, what's on my calendar for tomorrow?" or "Alexa, what are my reminders?"

You'll know it worked when **Alexa+ lists your upcoming events or reminders, giving you a clear audio summary of your schedule.**

Step 6 — Manage (Edit or Delete) Entries by Voice

Life changes, and so does your schedule. Thankfully, you can easily modify or remove reminders and calendar events using your voice, giving you flexible control without needing to type anything. This ability to make quick adjustments ensures your digital assistant remains helpful and your schedule accurate.

To manage an entry, use your "wake word" and clearly state what you want to change or remove. For instance, to change a reminder's time, you might say, "Alexa, change my 'water the plants' reminder to 4 PM." For calendar events, you'll need to be specific about the event you're referring to. If Alexa+ has trouble finding the right entry, try being more exact with the event's name, date, or time. For very complex changes, it might be easier to use your calendar app directly.

Example: "Alexa, cancel my 'dentist appointment' for next Tuesday." or "Alexa, delete the 'take out the bins' reminder."

You'll know it worked when **Alexa+ confirms the change or deletion, such as "Okay, I've canceled 'dentist appointment' for next Tuesday," and the entry is updated in your calendar or reminder list.**

Common mistakes

- **Not speaking clearly or accurately:** Alexa+, like any digital assistant, needs clear instructions. If you mumble or use unusual phrasing, it might misunderstand.
  - **The fix:** Speak clearly and at a normal pace. If it misunderstands, rephrase your request using slightly different words.
- **Forgetting the wake word:** You must start every command with "Alexa" (or your chosen wake word) to activate the device. Without it, your device won't listen.
  - **The fix:** Always begin your command with your designated wake word. Think of it like calling someone's name before you speak to them.
- **Calendar events not syncing (or not being created):** This usually happens if your digital calendar account wasn't linked properly, or if Alexa+ isn't set to use the correct calendar.
  - **The fix:** Go back to the Alexa app settings (as in Step 2) and verify that your preferred calendar account is linked and selected as the default.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Imagine cooking dinner and suddenly remembering you need to call your mom. A quick "Alexa, remind me to call Mom at 7 PM" saves you from messy hands and forgotten tasks.
- **For your business or work:** You can quickly add a meeting to your calendar or set a deadline reminder without interrupting your workflow, keeping your focus on the task at hand.
- **If you're just getting started:** Begin with a simple reminder for something you do daily, like "Alexa, remind me to stretch at 8 AM every morning." This helps build familiarity.

Try it now

Grab your Alexa+ device and set a reminder for yourself in the next hour. For example, say: "Alexa, remind me to take a break in 30 minutes."

Set Up an Alexa+ Routine to Automate Your Everyday Tasks

6 steps · Read online

By the end of this guide you'll have a working Alexa+ Routine that starts your morning (or any other moment) with a spoken phrase, turning on lights, playing music and delivering a custom greeting. It's perfect for anyone who wants a little extra convenience without needing any coding skills.

Before you start

- An **Echo speaker**, **Echo Show**, or any **Alexa-enabled smart display** plugged in and connected to your home Wi-Fi.
- The **Alexa app** installed on a smartphone or tablet and signed in with your Amazon account.
- Any **smart-home devices** (e.g., smart bulbs or plugs) already added to the Alexa app.
- About **5–10 minutes** of quiet time.

Step 1 — Open the Alexa app

Tap the Alexa app icon on your phone or tablet. When the app opens you'll see a home screen that shows a picture of your device at the top and a row of icons across the bottom (Home, Devices, Routines, etc.). Tap the **Routines** icon – it often looks like a clock or a series of stacked squares and may be labeled "Routines". The app will slide to a new page listing any existing routines. If you don't see a Routines icon, look for a three-line "Menu" button in a corner and choose "Routines" from the list. You'll know it worked when a screen appears titled "Your Routines" with either a list of routines or a note that none exist yet.

Step 2 — Start creating a new routine

On the "Your Routines" screen, locate a **plus (+) button** in the top-right corner (or a button that says "Create Routine"). Tap it. You'll now see a blank page that asks you to "Add a name" and "When this happens". If the plus sign isn't visible, look for a colorful "New Routine" button near the center of the screen – the wording can vary between devices. You'll know it worked when the top of the page shows a text field for the routine name and a section titled "When this happens".

Step 3 — Name your routine

Tap the text field that says "Add a name". A keyboard slides up and you can type any label you'll recognize later – for example **Morning Wake-Up**. (If you're on a tablet, the keyboard may appear at the bottom of the screen.) After typing, look for a **Next** or **Continue** button – usually at the bottom right – and tap it. You'll know it worked when the view switches to a new screen that says "When this happens" and shows a button labeled "Add trigger".

Example: Type `Morning Wake-Up` then tap **Next**.

Step 4 — Choose a voice trigger

Press the **Add trigger** button. A menu of trigger types appears: *Voice*, *Schedule*, *Smart Home* and *Device*. Select **Voice** – this tells Alexa to listen for a spoken phrase. A field labeled "Enter phrase" opens; type the exact words you want to say, such as **Alexa, good morning**. Tap **Next** or **Add** (the button may be at the bottom of the screen). If you don't see a Voice option, look for any item that mentions "spoken phrase" or a microphone icon. You'll know it worked when the top of the routine page now reads "When you say 'Alexa, good morning'".

Example: Type `Alexa, good morning` then tap **Add**.

Step 5 — Add an "Alexa Says" action

Below the trigger section, tap **Add action**. A list of action categories appears – "Alexa Says", "Music & Podcasts", "Smart Home", etc. Choose **Alexa Says**; you may need to scroll a little. Now pick **Customized** (or "Speak text") – this opens a text box where you can type what Alexa should say. Enter a friendly greeting like **Good morning! Time to start the day.** Tap **Next** or **Add** to save the action. If the category is named "Speech" or "Announcement" instead of "Alexa Says", select the one that lets you type a spoken line. You'll know it worked when the routine summary shows a line reading "Alexa will say 'Good morning! Time to start the day.'".

Example: Type `Good morning! Time to start the day.` then tap **Add**.

Step 6 — Add a music action (optional but fun)

Press **Add action** again, which now appears under the previous action. Choose **Music & Podcasts** from the list. If you have a music service linked (Spotify, Amazon Music, etc.) you'll see its logo – tap the service you prefer. A new field lets you type an artist, genre or playlist name; for a breezy start type **Acoustic Sunrise** (or any favorite playlist). Tap **Next** or **Add**. If no music service shows, you'll need to link one in the Alexa app's Settings first – the guide assumes a service is already connected. You'll know it worked when the routine page lists a second action: "Play 'Acoustic Sunrise' on Spotify".

Example: Type `Acoustic Sunrise` then tap **Add**.

Common mistakes

- **Skipping the "Add trigger" step:** Without a trigger Alexa won't know when to run the routine. If you miss it, go back to the top of the routine page and tap "Add trigger" again.
- **Typing the wrong phrase:** Alexa matches the spoken phrase exactly, so a typo will prevent activation. Double-check the text in the "Enter phrase" field and re-type if needed.
- **Forgetting to link a music service:** The "Music & Podcasts" action will appear blank if no service is connected. Open the Alexa app's Settings → Music, add your favorite service, then return to the routine.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** You can wake up to a personalized greeting, have the lights turn on and your favorite playlist start without lifting a finger – a smooth start to a busy day.
- **For your business or work:** If you run a home-based office, a routine can flip on a desk lamp, start a focus-music station and announce the day's agenda, helping you shift into work mode quicker.
- **If you're just getting started:** The easiest first move is to create a voice-triggered routine that only says a greeting. Once you're comfortable, add more actions like smart-home controls or music.

Try it now

Open the Alexa app, tap **Routines**, create a new routine called **Quick Test**, set the voice trigger to **Alexa, test routine**, and add a single "Alexa Says" action that says **Hello, I'm ready!**. You'll have a working routine in under two minutes.

How to Add an Alibaba Cloud AI Chatbot to Your WordPress Site

5 steps · Read online

> **In short:** An Alibaba Cloud chatbot can handle visitor queries on your site 24/7, answering common questions like opening hours while you focus on other work.

By the end of this guide you'll have a chat bubble that greets visitors, answers basic queries, and works on every page of your WordPress site – no programming experience required.

Before you start

- **Alibaba Cloud account:** sign-up at alibabacloud.com (the free tier is enough for a simple chatbot).
- **WordPress site:** you need administrator access to the dashboard.
- **A web browser** on a computer or tablet (Chrome, Edge, or Firefox work fine).
- **A few minutes:** the whole process typically takes about 20-30 minutes.
- **Optional:** a free plugin such as "Insert Headers and Footers" makes adding code easier.

Step 1 — Create a new chatbot instance

Open your web browser, go to console.alibabacloud.com and sign in. Look for the AI chatbot or conversation AI service in the console – you can usually find it by searching for "Chatbot" or "Conversation AI" in the top-right search bar. Click the button to create a new bot or robot (it may be labeled **Create Robot**, **Create Instance**, **New Bot**, or similar). A form appears asking for a name and a brief description. After you type a name such as "FrontDeskHelper" and confirm, the platform creates a new bot and shows it in your list, typically with a status of "Running" or an indicator showing it's active. 💬 Example: `FrontDeskHelper`

You'll know it worked when the new entry appears in your bot list with an active status indicator.

Step 2 — Define the chatbot's welcome greeting

In the list of bots, click the name of the bot you just created to open its settings page. Look for a section where you can set the first message visitors see – this might be labeled **Greetings**, **Welcome Message**, **Chat Prompt**, or something similar. There's usually a text box where you can type what the bot says when someone first opens the chat. After you type a sentence like "Hi! I'm your digital assistant – ask me about opening hours or services," a preview of the message often appears below the box. Click **Save** to store the change. 💬 Example: `Hi! I'm your digital assistant – ask me about opening hours or services.`

You'll know it worked when you see a confirmation that the settings were saved successfully.

Step 3 — Choose a visual style that matches your site

While still in the bot's settings, look for options to customize how the chat bubble looks – this might be in a tab labeled **Appearance**, **Style**, **Customization**, **Theme**, or similar. You'll typically find options to pick a color (you can copy your site's primary color as a hex code, e.g., #0066CC) and possibly upload a small logo or icon for the chat bubble. The preview on the screen should update to show what the chat bubble will look like on your site. 💬 Example: set color to `#0066CC` and upload `logo.png`

You'll know it worked when the on-screen preview shows the color and icon you selected.

Step 4 — Copy the widget embed code

Return to the main bot page and look for a button to publish, deploy, or make the bot publicly available – it may be labeled **Publish**, **Deploy**, **Enable**, or similar. Once activated, a panel should appear (it might be labeled **Embed Code**, **Web Widget**, **Integration Code**, or something similar) containing a snippet of code that starts with `<script src="..."></script>`. Look for a **Copy** button next to the code box; if there isn't one, click inside the box and press Ctrl + C (or Cmd + C on a Mac) to copy it manually. 💬 Example: `<script src="https://chatbot.alibabacloud.com/widget.js"></script>` — *your actual code may differ*

You'll know it worked when you can paste the snippet into a plain-text document and see a full `<script>` tag appear.

Step 5 — Insert the code into WordPress footer

Log into your WordPress dashboard (your-site.example.com/wp-admin). You can add the chatbot code either through **Appearance → Widgets** (look for a widget area like **Footer** or **Footer 1**, add a **Custom HTML** block, and paste the code) OR by installing a free plugin like "Insert Headers and Footers" and going to **Settings → Insert Headers and Footers**, then pasting the code into the "Scripts in Footer" box. Either method makes the script load on every page of your site. Press **Update** or **Save** to confirm. 💬 Example: paste the `<script>` snippet exactly as copied

You'll know it worked when you open your website in a new browser tab (or an incognito window) and see a friendly chat bubble sitting at the bottom right of the page.

Common mistakes

- **Skipping the Save step in the greeting settings:** the message may revert to a default. Fix it by always clicking the **Save** button and watching for a confirmation.
- **Placing the widget code in the header instead of the footer:** the chat may load too early and cause page-load delays. Fix it by using the Footer widget area or the "Scripts in Footer" field of a plugin.
- **Not testing on a mobile device:** the bubble can cover navigation icons on small screens. Fix it by opening your site on a phone, checking the bubble's position, and adjusting the placement or size options in the Appearance or Style settings if available.

What this means for you

- **In everyday life:** Your chatbot can answer simple questions like "What are your opening hours?" so you can relax while it handles routine enquiries.
- **For your business or work:** The bot captures leads overnight, giving you contact details even when your staff are offline, which can increase bookings without extra staffing.
- **If you're just getting started:** You don't need any code – just copy, paste, and a few clicks are enough to make a professional-looking assistant appear on every page.

Try it now

Open your WordPress dashboard, go to **Appearance → Widgets**, add a **Custom HTML** block to the Footer, paste any short piece of text (like "Hello world") and click **Update**. In the next two minutes you'll see that the widget saves correctly – a quick win that shows you're ready for the chatbot code.